

The Italian Gelato Market

Competitive Landscape and
Strategic Entry Opportunities



Executive Summary



- Artisanal vs. Packaged Retail
- Tourism + Authenticity
- Hybrid Brands

Recommended strategy:

- Flagship location →
restaurants/cafes → retail
distribution

History of Modern Gelato



Ancient China and Persia

- Early frozen desserts made with ice and fruit

Ancient Rome

- Snow + Honey + Fruit

Italy's Gelato Market



Packaged Retail Gelato Convenience and Scale	Artisanal Gelato Authenticity and Craft
Convenience	Premium Positioning
Distribution-Led	Experience-Led
Industrial Scale	Craft Production
Supermarkets	Gelaterias

Key Insight: Italy operates as two distinct markets: artisanal operators compete on authenticity and experience, while packaged brands compete on distribution and scale



Market Forecast of Packaged Retail

Store-Bought Market Leaders

Brand

Core Strength



Algida

Market Leader with unrivaled distribution and freezer coverage



Ferrero Ice Cream

Premium Positioning and global brands with high indulgence and innovation



Froneri

Innovation-driven portfolio and strong retail partnerships



Motta

Legacy Brand with strong recognition and consumer trust



Sammontana

Strong Italian heritage and artisanal expertise with a broad product portfolio

Italy Packaged Retail Gelato Market

€1.73B (2025)

In 2025

Projected to Reach

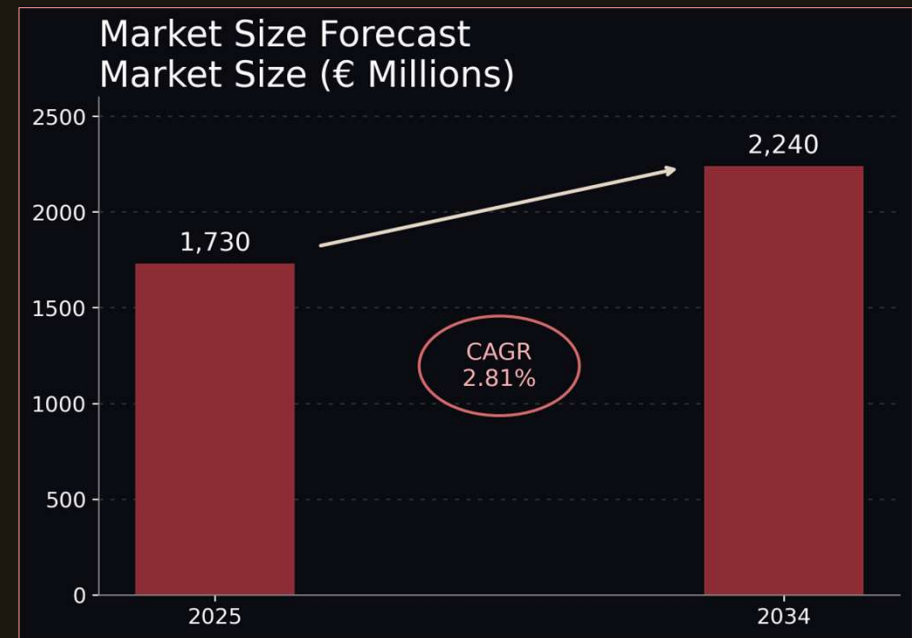
€2.24B (2034)

By 2034

With a CAGR of 2.81%

Key Growth Drivers

Premiumization • Tourism • Health & Wellness • Artisanal Appeal



Converted from IMARC USD estimates using approximate 2025 exchange rates



Consumer Purchasing Drivers



Retail Purchases

- Convenience/Accessibility
- Familiar brands
- Value for money and promotions
- Family Consumption

Gelateria Purchases

- Authenticity
- High-quality ingredients
- Visual appeal and artisanal craftsmanship
- Social experience and emotional connection

- Italian consumers purchase artisanal gelato for authenticity and experience, while retail purchases are driven by convenience and accessibility

Store-Bought Market Leaders



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Artisanal Gelato Leaders

Brand

Core Strength



La Romana

Premium artisanal gelato with a heritage of quality



Amorino

Distinctive flower-shaped gelato and a strong global brand appeal



Venchi

Luxury chocolate heritage and elevated dessert experience



Fassi

Historic Roman gelateria known for tradition and authenticity.



Giolitti

Iconic Italian brand with strong tourism appeal and heritage.



Source: Company Websites; Italian Gelato Industry Reports (202

Consumer Experience Insights



Key Review Themes	Strategic Implications
Product Quality	Build Trust and Loyalty through high-quality ingredients
Visual Representation	Drive Social Sharing through visual appeal/presentation
Flavor Variety	Flavor innovation/variety to increase visits
Customer Service	Warm interactions strengthen customer loyalty
Location & Convenience	Prime locations and convenient drive foot traffic lead to increased frequency of visits



Amorino: Lauren S.

“...it was an amazing experience. The staff was extremely accommodating, the gelato was amazing, and the presentation was even better...”



Venchi: Khadiji A.

“This gelato spot is famous for a reason and doesn't disappoint! You are able to sample as many flavors as you want ...The small has 2 flavors, medium up to 3, and grande up to 4.... Every flavor was so good and complimented each other. Definitely recommend!”

Hybrid Brands and Emerging Opportunity

	Grom	Artisanal roots with scalable retail and global expansion
	Antica Gelateria del Corso	Accessible premium gelato with artisanal quality and local authenticity
	Venchi	Multi-channel premium ecosystem spanning retail, e-commerce, and gelaterias
	Amorino	Unique flower-shaped gelato, strong global presence, and distinctive brand experience
	Sammontana	Strong national distribution and trusted heritage brand with broad consumer appeal



Growth Drivers of the Italian Gelato Market

Strong Tourism Demand and a large artisanal sector create a solid foundation for continued market growth

466.2M

Accommodation
Nights(2024)

Italy recorded 466.2
million
accommodation
nights in 2024

54.5%

Foreign Visitors

International travellers
generated 54.5% of
accommodation nights

~39,000

Gelaterias

Italy's artisanal gelato
sector includes
approximately 39,000
gelaterias.

€3.0B

Artisanal Gelato Sales

Estimated sales
generated by the
artisanal gelato sector

Italy benefits from strong tourism demand and a large artisanal base, reinforcing its position as a global gelato leader.

Emerging



Consumer Trends

Emerging Consumer Trends Cont.

1. Premiumization

Consumers continue trading up to premium products and experiences

2. Health-Conscious Products

Rising demand for vegan, lower-sugar, and clean-label options

3. Visual Branding

Presentation and social sharing influence purchasing decisions

4. Hybrid Retail Models

Brands combining artisanal credibility with retail convenience are gaining a strategic advantage

Successful brands increasingly combine premium positioning, strong customer experiences, and scalable distribution

Strategic Risks and Barriers to Entry

1. Distribution access

Retail freezer space is highly competitive and controlled by large incumbents and key retailers

2. Authenticity Expectations

Consumers expect genuine artisanal quality and credibility

3. Seasonality

Demand is concentrated in peak tourism periods

4. Input Cost Volatility

Dairy, nuts, cocoa, packaging, and energy costs remain volatile

5. Intense Competition

Competing against established heritage brands and thousands of independent gelaterias



Strategic Recommendation and Final Takeaways

1. Build Artisanal Credibility First
2. Quality over price
3. Use Social Media and Visual Branding
4. Expand Selectively Across Channels
5. Prioritize High-Tourism Locations



The strongest opportunity in Italy lies in a premium artisanal concept that leverages tourism demand, visual branding, and selective multi-channel expansion

Thank You!!

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